

MSP | MSP-22

End of Tranche Review Report

Assessment of tranche performance and readiness to proceed

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	End of Tranche Review Report
Document reference	MSP-22-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Programme Helios
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Sponsoring Group
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
MSP-09	Programme Business Case	Revalidated here
MSP-04	Target Operating Model	Interim state confirmed
MSP-15	Assurance Approach and Plan	Assurance input

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Reviews the capability delivered and benefits enabled by a tranche, confirms the interim operating state, and provides the basis for the decision to proceed to the next tranche.
Framework	MSP — Produced at each tranche boundary in Deliver the Capability
Created when	At each tranche boundary
Reviewed / updated	At the tranche boundary decision
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Sponsoring Group
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The interim operating state is confirmed as stable and operable, with evidence
- Benefits enabled by the tranche are evidenced, not asserted
- The business case is revalidated with current numbers
- Lessons are captured and routed before the next tranche begins

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1. Review identification

Field	Detail
Programme	Programme Helios
Tranche reviewed	31 Mar 2027
Tranche start / end	Helios AI Platform ART
Review date	18 Sep 2026
Reviewed by	23 Apr 2027
Next tranche	Tranche 1

2. Executive summary and recommendation

Programme Helios consolidates fragmented AI compute onto a single shared platform in DXB-1, scaling to 2,048 GPUs in Tranche 2 and 4,096 by Tranche 3. The decision requested is release of AED 118m of Tranche 2 capital at the 18 September 2026 gate.

The return is AED 14.3m of annual public cloud rental substituted, utilisation lifted from 31% to 72%, and median training cycle time cut from 11.5 days to 3 days. The principal risk to viability is vendor GPU allocation slipping beyond November 2026 (RSK-001), which would defer the benefit by a quarter.

3. Capability delivered

Capability	Planned	Delivered	Evidence	Accepted by
Signed container image supply chain	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	Partially	ALM tool — Helios ART board	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead
Self-service training environment provisioning	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance	Yes	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect
Experiment lineage and reproducibility	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	No	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead
Cross-hall workload failover	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance	Yes	Configuration management database	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead

4. Interim operating state

Confirm the organisation is in a stable, operable configuration. Where it is not, state what remains and how it is being managed.

Dimension	Target interim state	Actual state	Stable?	Residual actions
Processes	Implementing	Implementing	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	Secure written migration commitments from three business units
Organisation	Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform	Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform	Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform	Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform
Technology	Implementing	Implementing	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop
Information	Implementing	Implementing	Workshop with the affected workstream leads	Dashboard published to the programme site
Culture and behaviours	Implementing	Implementing	Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026

5. Project outturn

Project	Planned cost	Actual cost	Planned end	Actual end	Outputs accepted
WS8 Adoption and business change	AED 17,800,000	AED 11,200,000	31 Mar 2027	26 Feb 2027	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated
WS1 Facilities and power	AED 1,120,000	AED 240,000	26 Feb 2027	31 Jan 2027	Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply

Project	Planned cost	Actual cost	Planned end	Actual end	Outputs accepted
					chain
WS2 Compute and storage hardware	AED 91,200,000	AED 17,800,000	31 Jan 2027	15 Dec 2026	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills
WS3 Network fabric	AED 4,200,000	AED 1,120,000	15 Dec 2026	30 Nov 2026	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained

6. Benefits enabled and realised

Benefit ref	Benefit	Enabled ?	Target to date	Realised	Variance	Commentary
BEN-01	Reduced external GPU rental spend	Reduces median training cycle time from 11.5 days to 3 days	AED 5.1m per year by FY28	From Q3 2027	On profile	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune
BEN-02	Faster model training cycle time	Lifts average GPU utilisation from 31% to 72%	3 days median by Q4 2027	From Q2 2027	On profile	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme; outside programme control
BEN-03	Improved compute utilisation	Substitutes AED 14.3m of annual public cloud GPU rental	72% average utilisation by Q4 2027	From Q3 2027	On profile	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly
BEN-04	Reduced time to provision AI environments	Removes four standing data residency exceptions	2 hours self-service by Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	On profile	On plan; no intervention required this period
BEN-05	Data residency and sovereignty assurance	Cuts environment	Zero residency exceptions by	From Q3 2027	On profile	On plan; no intervention required this period

Benefit ref	Benefit	Enabled ?	Target to date	Realised	Variance	Commentary
		<i>provisioning from 23 working days to under two hours</i>	Q4 2027			
BEN-06	New revenue from AI-enabled products	<i>Improve s PUE from 1.62 to 1.21 across the estate</i>	AED 8.6m incremental revenue in FY29	From FY29	On profile	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly

7. Business case revalidation

Measure	At tranche start	At tranche end	Variance	Commentary
Total investment forecast	<i>Helios AI Platform ART</i>	18 Sep 2026	+2 weeks	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested
Total benefit forecast	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>
NPV	<i>Helios AI Platform ART</i>	30 Nov 2026	Nil	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested
Aggregate risk exposure	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>
Still desirable / viable / achievable?	<i>Helios AI Platform ART</i>	25 Jun 2027	Nil	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly

8. Risk and issue position

Measure	At start	At end	Commentary
Open risks	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Risks scored 15+	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Open issues	Helios AI Platform ART	25 Jun 2027	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly
Overdue actions	Helios AI Platform ART	25 Jun 2027	26 Feb 2027

9. Assurance findings

Review	Rating	Key findings	Actions	Status
31 Jan 2027	On plan; no intervention required this period	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026	Open
15 Dec 2026	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune	On plan; no intervention required this period	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	In progress
30 Nov 2026	On plan; no intervention required this period	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop	Complete
15 Oct 2026	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme; outside programme control	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	Not started

10. Stakeholder and readiness assessment

Engagement is weighted toward the two groups whose behaviour determines whether the benefit lands: the business units being asked to decommission departmental clusters, and the researchers being asked to change how they work. Fraud Analytics is currently resistant and is engaged directly by the Business Change Lead with the sponsor available to arbitrate on scheduling policy.

11. Lessons from this tranche

Lesson	Category	Recommendation	Applied to next tranche?
Hardware burn-in took 35 days against a 12-day estimate because firmware verification was performed serially on a single isolated VLAN	Planning and estimating	Model firmware verification as its own work package with parallel VLAN capacity sized for the shipment rate	Yes — reflected in the Tranche 2 schedule
The rate card decision was deferred twice because Finance and the business units were consulted sequentially rather than together	Governance and decision-making	Convene a single decision workshop with Finance and business unit heads together, with the sponsor present to break deadlock	Yes — workshop held 24 Sep 2026
Engaging vendor performance engineering for two weeks during commissioning lifted all-reduce efficiency from 79% to 84% in the first pass	Technical and design	Budget two weeks of vendor performance engineering per hall as a planned activity, not as a remedial response	Yes — included in the Tranche 2 estimate
A critical finding on cluster API exposure was discovered late because the test was scheduled after build completion	Security and compliance	Run a security design review at architecture sign-off and a first penetration test at 30% build, not only at completion	Yes — assurance plan revised
Fraud Analytics resistance was underestimated because engagement began after the decommissioning decision was announced	Stakeholder and communication	Assess attitude against observed behaviour, and engage those losing autonomy before the decision is communicated	Partially — engagement plan revised
Awarding fabric and platform work to a single partner created a concentration risk that later required a performance bond and step-in rights to manage	Procurement and suppliers	Include supplier concentration explicitly in source selection criteria for packages above AED 10m	No — for the next procurement

12. Readiness for the next tranche

Criterion	Assessment	Evidence	Met?
Capability embedded and stable	Level 3 — defined	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Signed container image supply chain
Resources secured	Approved establishment of	Approved establishment of 34	Approved

Criterion	Assessment	Evidence	Met?
	34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval	FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval	establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval
Funding approved	High residual exposure; active mitigation in place	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000
Dependencies confirmed	Acceptable — within tolerance	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	30 Nov 2026
Plan updated and baselined	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	18 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026
Business ready to absorb further change	High residual exposure; active mitigation in place	Configuration management database	Reduce Tranche 2 GPU count from 2,048 to 1,792

13. Decision

Item	Detail
Recommendation	[Proceed / Proceed with conditions / Pause / Close]
Sponsoring Group decision	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
Conditions attached	Performance bond of 10%, step-in rights, and design documentation held in escrow
Revised tolerances	Reported through the monthly benefit tracking report
Date	18 Sep 2026